

AI Prompt Guide for Students

Using AI as a research and visualization partner

AI is a great thinking partner for this project, but it is not always right about science. Use these prompts as starting points, then double-check anything AI tells you against a real source like National Geographic Kids, iNaturalist, or a science textbook.

1. Researching Your Animal

- "Tell me 3 verified facts about [your animal] that I can also confirm on a kids' science site."
- "What biome does [your animal] live in, and what dangers does it face there?"

Tip: Always ask AI where its information might be uncertain, and check at least one fact against a second source.

2. Understanding Current Adaptations

- "Explain how [adaptation] helps [your animal] survive. Is this structural, behavioral, or physiological?"
- "What is the difference between a structural and a physiological adaptation? Give an example from [your animal]."

Tip: If AI gives you a confusing answer, ask it to explain again 'like I'm in 5th grade.'

3. Imagining a New or Changing Environment

- "If [your animal] had to live in [new biome] instead, what new dangers or food sources might it face?"
- "How might [a human activity like deforestation/pollution] change [your animal]'s home over time?"

Tip: Pick a real environmental change when possible — it makes your project more powerful and true to life.

4. Predicting and Visualizing Future Adaptations

- "Based on [new environment], predict one adaptation [your animal] might evolve over millions of years. Explain the survival problem it solves."
- "Describe what this future adaptation might look like, so I can sketch or generate an image of it."

Tip: Always ask 'why would this actually help my animal survive?' — a fun idea still needs real science behind it.

5. Checking AI's Work (Most Important Step!)

- "Are you sure about that? What is a source or reasoning that supports this claim?"
- "What is a common mistake people make about [topic]? Did you avoid it here?"

Tip: If you ever catch AI getting a fact wrong, write it down — that's a great detail to include in your reflection slide!